



Honoured: In 2024, the USA — an Associate Member of the ICC — co-hosted the ICC Men's T20 World Cup. The national team exceeded expectations by defeating Pakistan and advancing to the Super 8s. Recognising this achievement, USA Cricket was honoured with the ICC Associate Member Men's Team Performance of the Year award at the recently held ICC Annual Conference in Singapore. USA Cricket CEO Johnathan Atkeison (left) and Chairman Venu Pisike (right) receive the award from the ICC Chairman, Jay Shah. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

33.3 per cent of all NGB boards of directors, executive boards, and other governing boards."

Just before the ICC AGM, an *ESPNcricinfo* report suggested that the ICC had proposed a full resignation of the USA Cricket Board as part of the roadmap for Olympic certification. However, the majority of board members have declined to resign, stating that it was only one of the three options suggested by USOPC.

And earlier in March this year, three former directors — Patricia Whittaker, Kuljit Singh Nijjar, and Arjun Rao Gona — removed from the board in December 2024, joined current director Atul Rai in suing the organisation and six sitting directors individually, alleging wrongful termination, governance lapses, and retaliation.

Can USA Cricket still govern the sport? Without independent control, strong audit rights, or leverage over its own revenues, USA Cricket risks failing its core mandate. The consequences go beyond league

disputes — the Board's very legitimacy, and its Olympic future, may hang in the balance.

Olympic stakes: USOPC certification risk

Cricket's inclusion at the Los Angeles 2028 Olympics gives this dispute regulatory teeth. In 2023, cricket was among five new sports approved for the LA28 programme by the International Olympic Committee (IOC), driven in part by the vast audience the game commands in the Indian subcontinent. As host, the United States is expected to field both men's and women's teams in a six-team medal competition.

The stakes were underscored in June 2024 when the U.S. co-hosted the men's T20 World Cup, staging matches across three venues — high-visibility proof of market potential ahead of LA28.

USA Cricket is an Associate Member of the ICC, not a Full Member — a status that comes with limited voting power and funding and that places a premium on

demonstrating robust governance and development pathways to progress within the ICC system.

Simply put, the structure of USA Cricket's deal with ACE risks putting it in violation of several governance standards laid out by the USOPC, the ICC, and the Ted Stevens Act — the U.S. law that defines the framework for National Governing Boards (NGBs) and their relationship with the USOPC.

Autonomy undermined

Section 220522.5 of the Ted Stevens Act demands that an NGB "demonstrates that it is autonomous in the governance of its sport, except with respect to the oversight of the organisation, in that it — (A) independently decides and controls all matters central to governance; (B) does not delegate decision-making and control of matters central to governance; and (C) is free from outside restraint." But USA Cricket's core operations — funding, league structure, infrastructure, scheduling — are controlled by ACE as per the Term Sheet (Sections 3, 4, 5, 22). USA Cricket's own audited financials show dependency on ACE advances to stay afloat — a breach of both spirit and letter.

Code of conduct concerns

Under 8.4.1 (a) (vi, vii) of the USOPC Bylaws, an NGB must "adopt and enforce a code of conduct for its employees, members, board of directors, and officers, including clear conflicts of interest principles, and adopt and enforce ethics policies and procedures."

USA Cricket's legal counsel at that time acknowledged that then-chair Marathe had a concurrent consulting contract with *Times Internet (UK)*.

This perception risk, combined with USA Cricket's failure formally to disclose or publicly to recuse Marathe during the 2019 deal-making phase, violates the "enforceability" requirement of the USOPC.

Lack of financial transparency

The USOPC Bylaw 8.4.1 (b), which lays down "Financial Standards and Reporting Practices" as part of Certification Standards for National Governing Bodies, requires every